



Continental Business & Finance Forum for SMEs

19–20 November 2026 | Kigali Serena Hotel · Rwanda

Presentation and Partnership Dossier



RWANDA EDITION · KIGALI 2026

TOGETHER, LET US BUILD THE CAPITAL BRIDGES THAT WILL FINANCE THE AFRICAN SMES OF TOMORROW.

The first transaction-driven forum dedicated to cross-border financing for African SMEs

- 250+ expected attendees
- USD 250–500 million in targeted financing
- Deal Room and NexoraPME

An initiative led by NetKigali · Re-Bird Belgium ·
SBPME-UEMOA · Congruence Consulting



TABLE OF CONTENTS

A structured overview of the positioning, transaction framework and proposed partnerships.

01	INTRODUCING THE CBFF-SME Origins, vision, objectives, ecosystem model and impact indicators.
02	WHY RWANDA National strengths, high-potential sectors and regional positioning.
03	CBFF DEAL ROOM Digital and physical framework, project preparation and post-Forum follow-up.
04	PANELS AND SPEAKERS The 3C methodology, speaker commitments and 2026 themes.
05	PARTICIPATION PACKAGES Access options, delegate benefits and included services.
06	STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS Investment, membership, Founding Partner status, Investor Club and targeted programmes.
07	PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES Strategic positioning options for institutions and key partners.

CORE POSITIONING

At the CBFF-SME, the objective is not simply to attend a forum. It is to join a network where decisions are made, partnerships are built and projects secure financing. For a bank, corporation, investment fund or development institution, every meeting can lead to a new client, a new partner, an investment opportunity or a new market. **That is the value we offer.**

01

INTRODUCING THE CBFF-SME

From connection to transaction: an architecture
designed to deliver results.

ORIGINS OF THE INITIATIVE

From a core conviction to a new pan-African ambition

The **CBFF-SME** was born from a simple **observation: Africa does not lack entrepreneurs. It lacks mechanisms capable of converting their potential into investment, partnerships and growth.**

This conviction emerged during an edition of **the UEMOA Banking and SME Forum (SBPME-UEMOA)** in Burkina Faso. Discussions among banks, investors, institutions and entrepreneurs highlighted a widely shared reality: economic forums create connections, but far too rarely lead to investment decisions.

African SMEs are not seeking visibility alone. They need a structured environment that facilitates access to capital, builds investor confidence and converts dialogue into tangible business opportunities.

Four key lessons emerged.

1. Dialogue alone is not enough

Conferences encourage discussion, but SMEs are primarily looking for financing solutions, commercial partners and measurable outcomes.

2. Trust must be strengthened

Banks and investors often struggle to assess SMEs because reliable, comparable and sufficiently structured information is lacking. Reducing this information asymmetry is essential to accelerating investment decisions.

3. Regional integration opens markets

The implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area is fundamentally reshaping the prospects of African businesses. SMEs must now be equipped to pursue opportunities beyond national borders.

4. Opportunities must be structured

Structured environments are essential to connect SMEs effectively with capital providers, buyers and partners.

A PAN-AFRICAN AMBITION LED BY A COMPLEMENTARY CONSORTIUM

To turn this vision into reality, four complementary organisations have combined their expertise to establish the **CBFF-SME**:

- **SBPME-UEMOA**, represented by its Permanent Secretary, **Youépéné Hermann NAGALO**, bringing more than a decade of experience in connecting banks and SMEs across West Africa;
- **Congruence Consulting**, represented by **Dorence MONKAM**, specialising in strategic advisory and business development;
- **Re-Biregium**, a gateway to European markets and international partnerships;
- **NetKigali**, represented by **Gloria KANSHARA**, an organisation committed to promoting entrepreneurship and innovation in Rwanda.

Together, they share one ambition: to make the CBFF-SME the leading pan-African platform for SME financing, strategic partnerships and business development.

More than a Forum: a permanent platform for growth

The CBFF-SME extends far beyond two days of meetings.

It is a permanent ecosystem that supports businesses at every stage of their development.

Through this platform, SMEs can:

- Access a qualified network of banks, investors, buyers and technical partners;
- Present their projects to selected decision-makers;
- Prepare their documentation and strengthen their credibility with financiers;
- Benefit from an intelligent matchmaking system based on their needs, sector and stage of maturity;
- Follow up on identified opportunities and convert initial contacts into lasting partnerships.

STRATEGIC VISION AND OBJECTIVES

Within five years, the CBFF-SME aims to become the leading pan-African platform connecting African SMEs with capital, markets and strategic partners.

Our vision is straightforward:

To build an ecosystem where entrepreneurs access the financing they need, investors identify credible opportunities and partnerships become engines of growth for African economies.

1. Mobilise capital

Facilitate connections between African SMEs and banks, investors, investment funds and development finance institutions.

2. Reduce investment risk

Prepare businesses, strengthen the quality of their documentation and improve information transparency in order to accelerate financing decisions.

3. Advance economic integration

Support cross-border trade and regional value chains within the framework of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA).

4. Accelerate market access

Connect African producers with buyers, distributors and commercial partners across the continent and internationally.

AN INTEGRATED APPROACH

The **CBFF-SME** is designed as a platform that converts opportunities into results. It prepares businesses, strengthens their credibility with financiers, facilitates high-value connections and accelerates their access to markets, capital and strategic partnerships across Africa and internationally.

THE FOUR COMPONENTS OF THE CBFF-SME ECOSYSTEM

01	COUNTRY-CBFF — ANNUAL IN-PERSON EDITION An edition is held each year in an African country. The inaugural Kigali edition brings national and international stakeholders together for two days around practical solutions for SME growth.
02	CBFF-SME MARKET — PAN-AFRICAN MARKETPLACE A transaction-oriented marketplace to be progressively deployed across the continent's major regions — West, Central, East and Southern Africa — to showcase the products, services and business opportunities of prepared SMEs.
03	NEXORAPME — MARKET INTELLIGENCE AND MATCHMAKING A digital platform using artificial intelligence and commercial data to identify export opportunities, qualify needs and connect SMEs with the most relevant partners.
04	BRUSSELS CONCEPT STORE — A GATEWAY TO THE EUROPEAN MARKET A permanent space at the heart of Europe to showcase, promote and commercialise the expertise of African SMEs. The “Made in... by...” concept connects national identity, the entrepreneur and the partners supporting the company's growth.

WHAT MAKES THE CBFF-SME UNIQUE

A platform designed to turn meetings into business opportunities

The **CBFF-SME** goes beyond organising a forum. It implements a **structured preparation, matchmaking and follow-up process** designed to turn exchanges among entrepreneurs, banks, investors and partners into concrete financing, partnership and business-development decisions.

Unlike conventional events, the CBFF-SME operates as a transaction **platform where every** interaction is prepared, targeted and directed towards a measurable outcome.

Its ambition is clear: **to reduce the time required to move from an initial meeting to an investment decision or a concluded partnership.**

A High-Value Matchmaking Process

The CBFF-SME is built on a proven methodology comprising four complementary stages:

1. PREPARE SMES

Over an eight- to twelve-week period, selected businesses receive support to strengthen their documentation, improve their bankability, structure their projects and prepare for meetings with financiers.

2. QUALIFY PARTNERS

Banks, investors, investment funds, financial institutions, buyers and technical partners are identified and selected according to their sector priorities, investment criteria and capacity to engage.

3. ORGANISE TARGETED MEETINGS

Through NexoraPME and the Deal Room, meetings are scheduled on the basis of SME needs, investor profiles and market opportunities in order to maximise the relevance and value of each exchange.

4. FOLLOW THROUGH TO COMPLETION

The Forum does not end with the closing ceremony. A structured follow-up mechanism supports the parties as discussions continue, due diligence is conducted, agreements are negotiated and initiated transactions progress towards completion.

A Results-Driven Deal Room

Its purpose is to accelerate the conversion of meetings into tangible outcomes, including:

- Investment decisions;
- Letters of Intent (LOIs);
- Term sheets;
- Financing mandates;
- Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs);
- Launch of due diligence processes;
- Commercial contracts;
- Strategic partnerships.

Each meeting is prepared to increase the likelihood of reaching a decision or a decisive milestone in the investment process.

Deliberately Selective Participation

The CBFF-SME prioritises the quality of interactions over participant volume.

The number of supported SMEs and invited partners is deliberately limited in order to:

- Guarantee high-value meetings;
- Improve the quality of matchmaking;
- Allocate more time to each business;
- Direct each SME towards the most relevant investors, buyers or partners;
- Encourage in-depth and productive discussions.

This approach optimises financing and partnership opportunities while strengthening

OBJECTIVES AND IMPACT INDICATORS (2026–2030)

INDICATOR	FIVE-YEAR TARGET	INTENDED IMPACT
SMEs prepared	150+ businesses	Development of a portfolio of structured, investment-ready and market-ready businesses.
SMEs supported annually	30 businesses	Tailored support for high-potential cohorts in strategic sectors.
Financing and transactions facilitated	USD 250–500 million	Capital mobilisation and acceleration of investment and partnership transactions.
Meeting conversion rate	Indicator monitored annually	Measurement of Letters of Intent, term sheets, mandates, contracts and financing generated through the Forum.
Post-Forum follow-up	30 – 60 – 90 days	Support for the parties through to the completion of initiated transactions.

A Clear Value Proposition

The CBFF-SME measures success not by the number of participants, but by the quality of the relationships created and the results achieved.

Its purpose is to build, year after year, the leading pan-African pipeline of prepared SMEs, connecting credible businesses with investors, financial institutions and strategic partners in a secure, structured environment focused on completing tangible transactions.

A NEW INITIATIVE BUILT ON ELEVEN YEARS OF EXPERIENCE

The CBFF-SME builds on a recognised track record of connecting financial institutions with African SMEs. It draws on the achievements of the UEMOA **Banking and SME Forum (SBPME-UEMOA)**, a leading regional initiative that has fostered dialogue among banks, businesses and public-sector stakeholders in West Africa for more than a decade.

Across **eleven editions held in the eight UEMOA Member States**, the SBPME-UEMOA has demonstrated its capacity to unite a robust ecosystem comprising governments, regional institutions, banks, financial institutions, technical and development partners, professional organisations, investors and entrepreneurs.

This experience has generated an in-depth understanding of SME expectations, financier requirements and the conditions required to build lasting partnerships.

The **CBFF-SME** now takes this momentum to the continental level. It does not replicate the SBPME-UEMOA model; it advances it through a more ambitious approach built on business preparation, qualified matchmaking, **a structured Deal Room**, post-Forum follow-up and support through to the completion of financing, investment and partnership transactions.

The CBFF-SME therefore combines proven experience with a resolutely results-driven pan-African platform serving the growth of African SMEs and the mobilisation of the capital required for their development.

PUBLIC AND REGIONAL INSTITUTIONS	BANKING AND FINANCIAL SECTOR	PRIVATE SECTOR AND PARTNERS
• Ministries of UEMOA Member States • Regional Consular Chamber • West African Development Bank (BOAD) • Central Bank of West African States (BCEAO) • African Guarantee and Economic Cooperation Fund (FAGACE) • UEMOA Regional Fund for Financial Services Development (FAPSFD-UEMOA) • Agence Universitaire de la Francophonie	• Coris Bank • Ecobank • Orabank • UBA • Vista Group • National development banks • Agricultural banks	• Entrepreneurs' associations • ASKY Airlines • International technical partners • Regional economic operators

02

WHY RWANDA

A business, innovation and regional-integration
environment conducive to transactions.

RWANDA: A REGIONAL BUSINESS PLATFORM

The decision to host the inaugural CBFF-SME edition in Rwanda reflects a strategic vision. Over the past two decades, the country has emerged as one of the continent's most dynamic economies through a determined policy of economic transformation, business-climate improvement and private-investment promotion.

Despite being landlocked, Rwanda has turned its geographic position into a competitive advantage by developing an open, connected economy firmly oriented towards regional and international trade. Kigali is now recognised as one of Africa's leading platforms for business, innovation, financial services and investment

By hosting the CBFF-SME, Rwanda provides entrepreneurs, investors, financial institutions and development partners with a stable, credible environment conducive to lasting partnerships. Kigali is therefore a natural convergence point for economic stakeholders seeking opportunities across East, Central and West Africa and, more broadly, throughout the continent under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA).

A Growth-Oriented Economic Ecosystem

Rwanda has progressively developed an environment conducive to entrepreneurship, innovation and investment, supported by institutional reforms, modern infrastructure and strong political commitment.

Its priority sectors offer extensive partnership and financing opportunities.

Agriculture and Agro-Industry

Rwanda has positioned itself in high-value agricultural value chains, including:

- Speciality coffee and tea, internationally recognised for their quality;
- Horticulture and export crops — including avocados, flowers, chillies, fine beans and other fresh produce — requiring efficient logistics chains;
- Agro-industry, with the development of processed products for regional and international markets.

Industry and Manufacturing

The country promotes industrial activities connected to African value chains, including:

- Construction materials;
- Manufacturing industries;
- Textiles and garment production;
- Technology, industrial assembly and digital solutions.

These sectors offer substantial opportunities for investors, financial institutions and industrial partners participating in the CBFF-SME.

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGES FOR EXPORT AND INVESTMENT

Rwanda offers a particularly favourable environment for businesses and investors through several differentiating factors.

Enabling Regulatory Framework Streamlined administrative procedures, investment-friendly regulation and governance recognised for its predictability.	Digital Infrastructure An advanced ecosystem of digital services, electronic payments and connectivity that supports business development.
Kigali International Financial Centre A financial platform designed to attract international investors, structure financial transactions and support pan-African investment.	Public-Sector Commitment A proactive policy supporting entrepreneurship, innovation, SMEs and productive investment.
Economic and Industrial Zones Industrial and logistics infrastructure providing favourable conditions for production, exports and investment.	Standards and Quality Progressive alignment with regional and international standards to facilitate trade and reduce non-tariff barriers.

03

CBFF DEAL ROOM

Two complementary mechanisms to move
from initial contact to decision.

TWO COMPLEMENTARY PILLARS SERVING SMES

The Digital Pillar: NexoraPME

Build profiles, qualify needs, organise matchmaking and schedule high-value transaction meetings.

The In-Person Pillar: The Deal Room

Conclude in person, deepen negotiations and formalise next steps with targeted partners.

The CBFF-SME does more than create opportunities to meet. It is designed as a genuine **qualified-matchmaking ecosystem** in which every interaction is prepared, targeted and directed towards a concrete result. Its ambition is to turn initial contacts into **partnerships, financing, contracts** and investments.

1. The Digital Pillar: NexoraPME, the CBFF-SME's Digital Engine

Well before the Forum opens, NexoraPME prepares exchanges through a structured qualification and matchmaking process.

This intelligent digital platform analyses participant profiles, sectors, needs, development objectives and project maturity to identify the most relevant matches.

Each participant can therefore:

- Create and showcase a company profile;
- Identify the investors, banks, buyers and technical or institutional partners best aligned with their objectives;
- Request targeted meetings;
- Prepare exchanges through access to profiles, business opportunities, participating experts and the meeting calendar.

More than a networking tool, **NexoraPME is a genuine "Digital Trust Lab"** where business relationships are prepared in a trusted environment using qualified information that helps accelerate decisions.

2. The In-Person Pillar: The Deal Room, Where Opportunities Become Transactions

During the two Forum days, meetings prepared in advance continue within the CBFF Deal Room.

This confidential setting is specifically designed to help participants move their discussions to the next stage: deepen project analysis, negotiate partnership terms, review technical or financial considerations and advance opportunities towards a decision.

The Deal Room provides a professional environment conducive to:

- Commercial negotiations;
- Investor-SME meetings;
- Engagement with banks and financial institutions;
- Strategic discussions between public- and private-sector partners;
- The signing of Letters of Intent, Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs), term sheets or other preliminary agreements.

The objective is clear: **to make the Forum a place where decisions are made, not simply where people meet.**

3. Why Combine Both Mechanisms? Prepare, Connect, Conclude

The strength of the CBFF-SME lies in the combination of its two complementary components.

Unlike conventional trade fairs, where meetings are often incidental, every CBFF-SME interaction is based on methodical preparation, qualified needs and a matchmaking process driven by profile relevance.

Meetings, generally scheduled in twenty-minute time slots, pursue a specific objective and systematically conclude with a clearly defined next step, such as:

- Providing additional information;
- Arranging a technical meeting;

- Submitting a financial proposal;
- Launching a due diligence process;
- Signing a Letter of Intent;
- Negotiating a mandate or partnership;
- Or initiating a contracting process.

This structured approach turns promising discussions into tangible business opportunities while ensuring rigorous follow-up before, during and after the Forum.

RECOGNISING PROGRESS

Businesses and partners that conclude an agreement or reach a decisive milestone through the CBFF-SME will be recognised during the VIP Dinner.

HOW DOES THE PLATFORM WORK?

The CBFF-SME is designed to provide every participant with a structured experience extending well beyond attendance at a forum. Each business follows a support journey that prepares meetings, facilitates engagement and maximises partnership opportunities.

The platform welcomes two main categories of participants:

- **SMEs**, seeking to grow their businesses, secure financing, enter new markets or establish strategic partnerships;
- **Ecosystem partners, including** banks, investors, investment funds, buyers, logistics providers, legal professionals, experts, business-support organisations, public institutions and specialised service providers contributing to SME development.

To ensure useful and productive meetings, each participant follows the steps below.

01

REGISTER FOR THE CBFF-SME (REGISTER AND ACCESS NEXORAPME)

Registration for the CBFF-SME is confirmed once participation has been approved and the applicable access fee has been paid.

Each participant then receives access to NexoraPME, the Forum's official digital platform and the entry point to the entire preparation process.

02

COMPLETE YOUR PROFILE AND SHOWCASE YOUR BUSINESS

Each participant completes a detailed profile presenting, in particular:

- The company and its activities;
- Its products or services;
- Its development projects;
- Its financing requirements;
- Its target markets;
- The partnerships it is seeking.

The more accurate and well-documented the profile, the more relevant the matchmaking opportunities will be.

03

COMPLETE THE SELF-ASSESSMENT (ASSESS YOUR READINESS)

SMEs then complete a self-assessment designed to measure their level of preparedness.

The assessment evaluates, among other factors:

- The quality of the documentation submitted;
- The maturity of the project;
- The company's ability to attract investors or partners;
- The main areas for improvement.

This information improves the quality of NexoraPME recommendations and supports matchmaking tailored to each participant's needs.

B2B Matchmaking.

04

SELECT MATCHES AND PREPARE TARGETED MEETINGS

Using the recommendations generated by NexoraPME, each participant can:

- Identify the most relevant counterparts;
- Review their profiles;
- Request meetings;
- Share useful documentation in advance;
- Define the objectives of each meeting.

Exchanges are therefore prepared in advance so that every meeting can lead to tangible progress.

DURING THE FORUM: FROM DISCUSSION TO OPPORTUNITY

Scheduled meetings take place in the CBFF Deal Room, a confidential environment specifically designed to facilitate negotiations and accelerate decision-making.

Participants can, in particular:

- Present their projects to investors;
- Meet banks and financial institutions;
- Engage with buyers, distributors and commercial partners;
- Negotiate strategic partnerships;
- Sign Letters of Intent (LOIs), Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs), term sheets or other preparatory agreements.

The objective is to make the Forum a genuine accelerator of decisions and transactions.

AFTER THE FORUM: CONVERTING INTENTIONS INTO RESULTS

Support continues after the event to ensure that identified opportunities progress towards completion.

The framework includes:

- Automated reminders supporting the completion of actions agreed between participants;
- Follow-up at 30, 60 and 90 days to measure progress, identify potential obstacles and help address them;
- Continued access to Forum-related benefits and preferential conditions until 30 November 2026, giving participants sufficient time to finalise negotiations;
- Ongoing access to NexoraPME from December 2026 onwards, according to the package selected by each user.

04

PANELS **AND SPEAKERS**

Concise, practical contributions designed
to deliver immediate value to SMEs.

CBFF-SME PANEL METHODOLOGY

CBFF-SME Panels: Discussions That Lead to Solutions

At the CBFF-SME, panels are not conventional conferences. They are designed as **genuine decision** workshops in which every speaker provides practical solutions that SMEs, investors and partners can apply immediately.

Each panellist joins a “Results Consortium” and commits to delivering useful, measurable and action-oriented content.

A Methodology Based on the 3C Rule

Every contribution must meet three criteria: Concrete, Costed and Contract-ready. Each presentation is followed by a focused five-minute exchange. At the end of the panel, a speed-coaching session allows selected SMEs to explore specific issues in greater depth.

CONCRETE

Present a directly applicable solution, process, method or practical case study.

COSTED

Support proposals with quantified data, costs, timelines, thresholds or measurable outcomes.

CONTRACT-READY

Define a next step capable of leading to a mandate, offer, agreement or transaction.

COMMITMENTS OF PANELLISTS AND MODERATORS

A Dynamic Format

Each panel lasts 60 minutes:

- 3 panellists and 1 moderator;
- 15 minutes per speaker;
- 5 minutes of focused audience discussion;
- 15 minutes of Speed Coaching after the panel with pre-selected SMEs.

The objective is to turn discussion into concrete business opportunities.

Panellist Commitments

Each speaker commits to:

- Prioritising practical solutions over institutional presentations;
- Sharing at least one tool, template or guide that participants can use;
- Taking part in a Speed Coaching session with selected SMEs;
- Helping to define the next steps required to advance projects.
- Avoid institutional presentations focused solely on the organisation;
- Provide at least one downloadable tool, template or resource for participants;
- Participate in a fifteen-minute speed-coaching session with selected SMEs;
- Contribute to defining concrete next steps following the discussions.

THEMES AND TARGET PROFILES — RWANDA 2026 EDITION

01

INVESTING FROM RWANDA: WHY AND HOW?

Objective: Present the legal, financial, tax and operational conditions required to understand why and how Rwanda can be used as a regional platform for investment and business development.

Target profiles: Representative of KIFC or RDB, pan-African investor, or a company that has expanded its activities from Rwanda.

Practical deliverable: Practical Guide for Investors in Rwanda.

02

BLENDING PUBLIC AND PRIVATE CAPITAL TO REDUCE SME RISK

Objective: Present mechanisms showing how public and private financing, combined with guarantees, can improve access to finance.

Target profiles: Development finance institution, risk-management executive from a commercial bank, investment fund or guarantee mechanism.

Practical deliverable: Case study on structuring a guaranteed financing solution.

03

AFCFTA CORRIDORS: FINANCING CROSS-BORDER TRADE

Objective: Reduce barriers relating to cross-border payments, foreign exchange, transport and credit insurance, while facilitating payments, logistics, insurance and regional trade.

Target profiles: PAPSS representative, freight forwarder specialising in the Rwanda–DRC–Tanzania corridors, export credit insurance expert and MINICOM export specialist.

Practical deliverable: Full simulation of a cross-border transaction.

04

FROM KIGALI TO BRUSSELS AND CANADA: SUCCESSFULLY ENTERING INTERNATIONAL MARKETS

Objective: Understand the regulatory, commercial and quality requirements of European, Canadian and other international markets.

Target profiles: Expert in EU/Canada–Africa trade agreements, specialist in phytosanitary and ESG standards, buyer from a major retail group, or international business lawyer.

Practical deliverable: Product stress test comparing standard packaging with packaging aligned with premium-market expectations, together with a comparative export-readiness assessment.

05	YOUTH AND FINTECH: ACCELERATING FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP Objective: Identify digital solutions capable of reducing costs, improving access to finance and supporting young businesses. Target profiles: Fintech founder, bank or payment operator, young entrepreneur, investor or accelerator. Practical deliverable: Demonstration of a fintech solution and an investor-pitch preparation framework.
06	SECURING CROSS-BORDER TRANSACTIONS: FROM LETTER OF INTENT TO ENFORCEABLE CONTRACT Objective: Equip SMEs with the legal and compliance tools required to secure their international commitments. Target profiles: International business lawyer with expertise in OHADA law and Common Law, notary or registrar of the Kigali Commercial Court, compliance officer from a pan-African bank, or AfCFTA expert. Practical deliverable: Exporter's legal toolkit, including term-sheet templates, arbitration clauses, contractual provisions and key risk considerations.
04	SHEFLIES TO TRADE — WOMEN AND INTERNATIONAL TRADE: REIMAGINING THE MODEL Objective: Address the financing, mobility, logistics and market-access barriers faced by women entrepreneurs. Target profiles: Woman export entrepreneur, financial institution or fund, airline or logistics operator, and organisation supporting trade and women's entrepreneurship. Practical deliverable: SheFlies to Trade roadmap and practical recommendations to facilitate business travel and exports.

A Fundamental Difference

At the CBFF-SME, the success of a panel is measured not by attendance, but by the number of opportunities created. Every session is designed to produce practical deliverables, facilitate qualified meetings and accelerate the conclusion of partnerships, financing arrangements and contracts.

DETAILED PROGRAMME IN PREPARATION

The official programme will specify the timetable, speakers, moderators and final format of each session.

It will include, in particular:

- The opening ceremony and institutional addresses;
- Thematic panels and speed-coaching sessions;
- B2B meetings and Deal Room sessions;
- The VIP Dinner and qualified networking sessions.

The detailed programme will be released shortly.



05

PARTICIPATION PACKAGES

Two access levels designed to meet
each delegate's objectives.

PARTICIPATION PACKAGES AND DELEGATE BENEFITS

Select the package best aligned with your participation objectives

EUR 250 PACKAGE — PARTICIPANT BADGE	EUR 500 PACKAGE — PREMIUM BADGE
• Access to all panels • Standard access to the Deal Room for one month • Networking cocktail reception • Visit to the Memorial to the Genocide against the Tutsi • Airport meet-and-greet and transfer to the hotel upon arrival • Transfers between the hotel and the event venue during both Forum days • Breakfast at the event hotel • Lunch at the event venue • Preferential rates negotiated with partner hotels • Discount codes with RwandAir, Brussels Airlines and Ethiopian Airlines	• Access to all panels • Premium Pro access to the Deal Room for three months • Personalised matchmaking • Tailored support for B2B and B2G meetings • Networking cocktail reception • Speed coaching with experts and panellists • VIP Dinner • Visit to the Memorial to the Genocide against the Tutsi • Airport meet-and-greet and transfer to the hotel upon arrival • Transfers between the hotel and the event venue during both Forum days • Breakfast at the event hotel • Lunch at the event venue • Preferential rates negotiated with partner hotels • Discount codes with RwandAir, Brussels Airlines and Ethiopian Airlines

06

STRATEGIC **PARTNERSHIPS**

Invest in a pan-African platform providing access to markets, capital and qualified opportunities.

BECOME A STRATEGIC PARTNER OF THE CBFF-SME — KIGALI 2026

The CBFF-SME is not simply a visibility event. It is a gateway to a qualified pan-African market, designed to enable banks, corporations, investors and institutions to identify new markets, meet prepared partners, explore new countries, build an opportunity pipeline and accelerate their continental expansion.

Level 1 – Visibility Brand exposure, media, communications and premium institutional presence.	Level 2 – Influence Panels, thought leadership, expert content, studies and high-value speaking opportunities.
Level 3 – Business Deal Room, matchmaking, Investor Club, Buyers Club and commercial opportunities.	Level 4 – Legacy Founding status, strategic governance, long-term access and priority for future editions.

WHO WILL YOU MEET?

- Public- and private-sector decision-makers;
- Investors, funds, banks and development finance institutions;
- High-potential SMEs, exporting businesses and prepared project sponsors;
- Buyers, distributors, logistics providers and technology partners;
- Investment-promotion agencies, business networks, media and technical partners.

What Your Strategic Investment Enables

- IDENTIFY markets, sectors and projects aligned with your priorities;
- ACCESS a pan-African pipeline of qualified SMEs and opportunities;
- SHAPE financing, trade and regional-integration solutions;
- DEVELOP new clients, partnerships, investments and trade corridors;
- MEASURE the results generated before, during and after the Forum.

FROM FORUM TO PERMANENT NETWORK

The Forum lasts two days. The network operates throughout the year.

Depending on the selected package, the partner joins the CBFF Africa Business Network and gains access to NexoraPME, virtual Deal Rooms, trade missions, webinars, market reports and the investor community.

MEASURABLE RETURN ON INVESTMENT

Each partnership is supported by reporting tailored to its scope. The CBFF-SME measures not only visibility, but also the business and institutional value actually generated.

- Number and quality of meetings held;
- Sectors, countries and profiles engaged;
- Qualified contacts and opportunities identified;
- Negotiations, mandates, Letters of Intent or partnerships initiated;
- Progress tracked at 30, 60 and 90 days;
- Opportunities converted and recommended next actions.

OVERVIEW OF PARTNERSHIP LEVELS

LEVEL	CONTRIBUTION	STATUS	NETWORK ACCESS	ACTIVATION
FOUNDING	100 000 USD	Founding Partner	Council + 5 editions	Flagship initiative
OR	50 000 USD	Title Partner	Annual network + 12 accesses	Meeting room for 2 days + 18 m ²
ARGENT	25 000 USD	Principal Partner	Annual network + 7 accesses	Meeting room for 1 day + 12 m ²
BRONZE	10 000 USD	Strategic Partner	6-month network + 5 accesses	Meeting room for 1 day + 9 m ²

DETAILED PARTNERSHIP LEVELS

FOUNDING PARTNER — CBFF-SME Founding Partner

A historic status reserved for organisations committed to building the ecosystem over the long term.

USD 100,000

STATUT FONDATEUR ET HÉRITAGE

- Status as a CBFF-SME Founding Partner and historic partner;
- Limited to a maximum of five organisations for the inaugural Kigali edition;
- Permanent recognition among the co-builders of the CBFF-SME ecosystem;
- Official partner of the Forum's first five editions;
- Long-term association with a flagship initiative: the Deal Room, Export Lab, SheFlies to Trade, Africa Buyers Club or an equivalent programme.

GOVERNANCE AND FIVE-YEAR VISION

- One seat on the CBFF-SME Strategic Advisory Council;
- Participation in strategic direction-setting and the platform's annual reviews;
- Priority renewal rights and a right of first refusal for future editions;
- Preferential conditions guaranteed for three editions;
- Permanent legacy visibility on NexoraPME and across future-edition materials.

BUSINESS, MEMBERSHIP AND ACCESS

- Annual access to NexoraPME and the CBFF Africa Business Network across five editions;
- Access to virtual Deal Rooms, trade missions and invitation-only meetings;
- Exclusive market reports and priority access to the investor community;
- Strategic matchmaking with targeted decision-makers, SMEs, buyers and partners;
- Private meeting room and VIP delegation package at Kigali 2026.

LEADERSHIP, VISIBILITY AND ROI

- High-level speaking opportunities and editorial visibility across flagship content;
- Founding co-branding across institutional and digital communications;
- Comprehensive performance report covering visibility, meetings, contacts, sectors and opportunities;
- Follow-up on negotiations and opportunities at 30, 60 and 90 days;
- Annual review of results and converted opportunities.

GOLD — Title Partner & Founding Member

The signature partnership: your brand becomes the face of the Forum and joins the year-round network.

USD 50,000

STATUS AND EXCLUSIVITY

- Exclusive Title Partner status: "CBFF-SME 2026, presented by [Your Brand]";
- Sector exclusivity: no direct competitor admitted at Gold level;
- Automatic Founding Member status within the CBFF Africa Business Network;
- Branding rights for a major Forum segment — either the Deal Room or VIP Dinner.

VISIBILITY AND INFLUENCE

- First-position premium logo placement on the main banner and all key materials;
- Enhanced partner profile on NexoraPME, including video, link and expert content;
- National and international media coverage, an exclusive interview and a co-branded press release;
- Main address, plenary session and branded masterclass or workshop;
- Head-table placement at the VIP Dinner and priority recognition at the opening and closing ceremonies.

BUSINESS, DEAL ROOM AND MEMBERSHIP

- Priority access to the pipeline, Deal Room and investor–SME matchmaking;
- Up to 12 accesses to NexoraPME and the Deal Room;
- Private meeting room for both Forum days;
- Annual access to virtual Deal Rooms, webinars, missions and market reports;
- Full access to the delegate and SME directory, subject to confidentiality rules.

DELEGATION, RECOGNITION AND ROI

- 12 Delegate Passes, 5 VIP Investor Passes and an 18 m² premium exhibition stand;
- Gold Partner Trophy and official certificate of recognition;
- Comprehensive performance report covering meetings, contacts, sectors and opportunities;
- Follow-up on negotiations and opportunities at 30, 60 and 90 days;
- Priority renewal for future editions.

SILVER — Principal Partner & Member

High visibility, privileged business access and active participation in the year-round network.

USD 25,000

STATUS AND VISIBILITY

- Principal Partner status with prominent positioning throughout the event;
- Branding of a dedicated Forum area;
- Logo placement on selected materials, the application and event recordings;
- Media coverage, interview, press mentions and a dedicated digital publication.

LEADERSHIP AND INFLUENCE

- Keynote address or panel leadership with a thematic speaking role;
- Address during the opening ceremony and VIP recognition;
- Participation in a jury, coaching or expert-content session;
- Reserved table at the VIP Dinner.

BUSINESS AND MEMBERSHIP

- Priority access to the Deal Room and up to 7 platform accesses;
- Dedicated meeting room for one Forum day;
- Twelve-month membership of the CBFF Africa Business Network;
- Access to webinars, virtual Deal Rooms, market reports and selected missions;
- Access to the delegate and SME directory, subject to confidentiality rules.

DELEGATION AND ROI

- 7 Delegate Passes, 2 VIP Investor Passes and a 12 m² exhibition stand;
- Official certificate of recognition;
- Performance report covering meetings, contacts and opportunities;
- Opportunity follow-up at 30, 60 and 90 days.

BRONZE — Strategic Partner & Member

Strong brand presence, in-depth access to opportunities and continued engagement after the Forum.

USD 10,000

VISIBILITY AND POSITIONING

- Logo placement on the main banner and selected materials;
- Partner profile on the website and brand presence in event recordings;
- Media coverage, press mentions and a dedicated social-media publication;
- VIP recognition at the opening and closing ceremonies.

LEADERSHIP AND BUSINESS

- Leadership of a session or speaking role on a panel;
- Up to 5 Deal Room accesses;
- Dedicated meeting room for one day;
- Attendance at the VIP Dinner.

MEMBERSHIP AND DELEGATION

- Six-month membership of the CBFF Africa Business Network;
- Access to NexoraPME, webinars and one virtual Deal Room;
- 3 Delegate Passes, 1 VIP Investor Pass and a 9 m² exhibition stand;
- Access to the delegate and SME directory, subject to confidentiality rules.

RECOGNITION AND ROI

- Official certificate of recognition;
- Performance report covering meetings, qualified contacts and identified opportunities;
- Summary follow-up on opportunities at 30, 60 and 90 days.

TARGETED PROGRAMMES AND PARTNERSHIPS

In addition to the four partnership levels, the CBFF-SME offers eight targeted programmes built around the platform's most strategic assets. These may take the form of membership, a technical partnership, programme co-financing, a financial contribution or an in-kind contribution with an agreed value.

OVERVIEW OF TARGETED PROGRAMMES

Programme	Contribution	Positioning	Flagship Activation	Access
Investor Club	Tailored	Origination & investment	Pipeline + private Deal Room	Qualified opportunities
Country Investment Program	USD 50,000	Economic diplomacy	Pavilion + country day	Agenda + 12-month follow-up
Fintech & Payments	USD 15,000	Financial inclusion	Demonstration + use case	4 badges + targeted meetings
Deal Room & Financing	USD 20,000	Access to capital	Naming rights + investor sessions	5 VIP passes + meeting room
SheFlies to Trade	USD 5,000	Women's entrepreneurship	Mobility + mentoring + markets	3 VIP passes + Deal Room
VIP Dinner	USD 15,000	High-level relationships	Naming rights + hosting	10 invitations + host table
Sustainable Finance & Impact	USD 10,000	Responsible investment	ESG session + practical case	5 badges + Deal Room
Trade & Logistics	USD 10,000	AfCFTA corridors	Panel + demonstration	5 VIP passes + B2B

CBFF INVESTOR CLUB

A confidential circle providing access to the strongest opportunities and the best-prepared entrepreneurs.

BY SELECTION

ELIGIBLE MEMBERS

- Commercial banks and development banks;
- Private equity funds, venture capital funds and asset managers;
- Sovereign wealth funds, family offices and institutional investors;
- Development finance institutions and guarantee mechanisms.

PIPELINE AND PRE-QUALIFICATION

- Access to a pipeline of prepared and documented SMEs;
- Matching based on each member's sector, geographic and financial criteria;
- Pre-screening profiles and information shared in accordance with confidentiality rules;
- Referral to opportunities requiring in-depth due diligence.

PRIVATE DEAL ROOM AND MEETINGS

- Confidential sessions with the most relevant businesses;
- Investor-SME meetings prepared in advance;
- Option to organise investment committees, financing clinics or technical meetings;
- Access to the network's virtual Deal Rooms and trade missions.

FOLLOW-UP AND PERFORMANCE

- Follow-up on opportunities and next steps at 30, 60 and 90 days;
- Reporting on opportunities reviewed, negotiations initiated and opportunities converted;
- Annual access to NexoraPME under the agreed membership package;
- Participation in the CBFF-SME investor community.

COUNTRY INVESTMENT PROGRAM — COUNTRY PARTNER

A twelve-month international investment-promotion, trade and economic-diplomacy campaign.

USD 50,000

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Official "Country Partner" status;
- National pavilion or customised delegation area;
- Promotion of priority sectors, investment projects and flagship businesses;
- Production of a concise country guide for investors and partners;
- Media programme and dissemination of country content before, during and after the Forum.

ECONOMIC DAY AND LEADERSHIP

- Organisation of an economic day or dedicated country session;
- Investment session presenting priority projects and opportunities;
- Address by an official representative and targeted institutional meetings;
- Country-branded networking reception.

BUSINESS AND ECONOMIC DIPLOMACY

- Selection of a delegation of priority businesses, buyers and projects;
- Tailored B2B/B2G agenda with investors, institutions and commercial partners;
- Privileged access to the Deal Room and matchmaking;
- Connections to the CBFF-SME's regional networks.

TWELVE-MONTH FOLLOW-UP AND ROI

- Digital investment-promotion campaign before, during and after Kigali 2026;
- Twelve-month follow-up on contacts, expressions of interest and opportunities;
- Country performance report covering meetings, promoted projects, leads and negotiations;
- Recommendations for future missions, editions and conversion activities.

FINTECH & PAYMENTS PARTNER

Position your solutions at the heart of African SME transactions.

USD 15,000

Designed for banks, fintechs, payment operators, insurers and technology companies, this partnership showcases solutions that secure payments, advance financial inclusion and improve access to finance.

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Naming rights for the “Fintech & Payments” session;
- Branding of the demonstration area and partner profile on NexoraPME;
- Dedicated digital communications before, during and after the Forum.

LEADERSHIP AND DEMONSTRATION

- Speaking role on the “Youth and Fintech” panel;
- Demonstration of a solution or practical use case;
- Participation in speed coaching with selected SMEs;
- Media interviews and expert content.

BUSINESS AND ACCESS

- 5 partner accreditations;
- Targeted meetings with SMEs, banks, investors and trade stakeholders;
- Deal Room access for accredited representatives.

DEAL ROOM & ACCESS TO FINANCE PARTNER

Associate your brand with the transaction hub of the CBFF-SME.

USD 20,000

Designed for banks, development institutions, funds, investors and guarantee mechanisms, this partnership provides central visibility within the framework that converts meetings into decisions.

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Official naming rights for the CBFF Deal Room;
- Branding at the entrance, in meeting rooms and on associated materials;
- Brand presence in communications focused on transactions.

LEADERSHIP AND EXPERTISE

- Opening remarks for an investor–SME session;
- Leadership of a financing or investment clinic;
- Deployment of experts for meetings and speed-coaching sessions.

BUSINESS AND IMPACT

- 5 VIP accreditations and priority matchmaking;
- Dedicated meeting room for one day;
- Access to the pipeline of prepared SMEs, subject to confidentiality rules;
- Follow-up report at 30, 60 and 90 days on initiated opportunities.

SHEFLIES TO TRADE PARTNER

Accelerate women entrepreneurs' access to finance, mobility and markets.

5 000 USD

Designed for banks, impact funds, airlines, logistics providers and development organisations, this partnership supports practical solutions for selected women entrepreneurs.

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Exclusive brand association with the "SheFlies to Trade" programme;
- Branding of workshops and dedicated content;
- CSR and impact communications before, during and after the Forum;
- Promotion of programme testimonials and results.

LEADERSHIP AND ENGAGEMENT

- Speaking opportunity during the SheFlies to Trade session;
- Participation in mentoring or speed coaching;
- Opportunity to support a mobility, financing, logistics or market-access solution.

BUSINESS AND IMPACT

- Targeted meetings with selected women entrepreneurs and ecosystem partners;
- Deal Room access and 3 VIP accreditations;
- Impact report covering beneficiaries, meetings, commitments and generated opportunities.

VIP DINNER & NETWORKING PARTNER

Host the Forum's circle of decision-makers and investors.

USD 15,000

The VIP Dinner brings together ministers, business leaders, investors, development banks and institutional partners in a privileged setting designed to foster strategic engagement.

NAMING RIGHTS AND VISIBILITY

- Official naming rights for the VIP Dinner;
- Branding of the venue and reception area;
- Logo placement on invitations and dinner-related materials.

LEADERSHIP AND HOSPITALITY

- Partner welcome address;
- Premium host table with 10 VIP invitations;
- Strategic seating coordinated with the organisers, subject to protocol requirements;
- Opportunity to host a brief transaction-recognition segment.

BUSINESS AND CONTENT

- Deal Room access for accredited representatives;
- Brand activation or gifts, subject to organiser approval;
- Photo and video coverage;
- Dedicated digital content after the event.

SUSTAINABLE FINANCE & IMPACT PARTNER

Finance more resilient SMEs and responsible value chains.

USD 10,000

Designed for banks, climate funds, development institutions, insurers and ESG stakeholders, this partnership connects sustainable finance with concrete, prepared SME projects.

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Naming rights for the "Sustainable Finance & Impact" session;
- Branding of the thematic area;
- Presence across partner materials;
- Dedicated digital communications.

LEADERSHIP AND IMPACT

- Speaking role in a session on responsible finance and ESG criteria;
- Presentation of a practical case or financing instrument.

BUSINESS AND ACCESS

- Connections with SMEs, impact funds and development institutions;
- 5 accreditations and Deal Room access;
- Briefing note on identified impact projects and opportunities.

CROSS-BORDER TRADE & LOGISTICS PARTNER

Facilitate trade corridors, payments and market access.

USD 10,000

Designed for airlines, logistics providers, carriers, insurers, customs-solution providers and payment operators, this partnership supports the practical execution of regional trade.

POSITIONING AND VISIBILITY

- Naming rights for the “Cross-Border Trade & Logistics” sessions;
- Branding of the thematic area;
- Dedicated communications before, during and after the event.

LEADERSHIP AND DEMONSTRATION

- Leadership of a panel on AfCFTA corridors;
- Demonstration of a logistics, payment, insurance or traceability solution;
- Presentation of a practical case covering the timelines, costs and risks of a transaction.

BUSINESS AND FOLLOW-UP

- B2B meetings with exporters, buyers, institutions and corporate clients;
- Privileged Deal Room access;
- 5 VIP accreditations;
- Report on generated commercial opportunities.

A MONITORED, DOCUMENTED AND MEASURABLE INVESTMENT

Each partner receives reporting proportionate to its programme, covering visibility achieved, meetings held, sectors and countries engaged, qualified contacts, opportunities identified and negotiations initiated. Follow-up at 30, 60 and 90 days documents progress, conversions and the next actions required to bring transactions to completion.

07

PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

Tailored positioning opportunities for institutions,
financiers, corporations and technical partners.

STRATEGIC POSITIONING PROPOSALS

The positioning options below provide a basis for discussion by partner category. They can be adapted to each organisation's mandate, objectives, budget and priorities.

01

INSTITUTIONAL PARTNER

Public-Sector Leadership and National Anchoring

Partner profiles: Ministries, public agencies, local authorities and national institutions

Strategic rationale: Public-sector anchoring strengthens the Forum's credibility, facilitates the mobilisation of economic stakeholders and aligns outcomes with national priorities.

Proposed positioning: Patronage or institutional partnership, a role in the opening ceremony, contribution to the steering committee and official visibility.
Key benefits: Showcase SME-supportive policies • Engage with investors • Promote the national ecosystem

Expected return: Stronger institutional mobilisation and enhanced positioning of the host country as a business platform.

02

INVESTMENT & MARKET ACCESS PARTNER

Investment Promotion, Export Development and Market Entry

Partner profiles: Investment- and export-promotion agencies, chambers of commerce and business associations

Strategic rationale: These organisations convert the interest generated by the Forum into market-entry, export, procurement and partnership projects.

Proposed positioning: Country or sector desk, tailored B2B/B2G agenda and practical market-access session.

Key benefits: Generate qualified leads • Promote business-support services • Showcase priority sectors

Expected return: Concrete investment, trade and expansion opportunities for supported businesses.

03

DEAL ROOM & FINANCING PARTNER

Capital, Credit and Transactions

Partner profiles: Commercial and development banks, funds, investors and asset managers

Strategic rationale: The Deal Room provides access to a prepared pipeline and directs each meeting towards a financing or investment decision.

Proposed positioning: Financial partner of the Deal Room, participation in financing clinics and confidential access to qualified opportunities.

Key benefits: Originate transactions • Acquire new SME clients
• Structure co-financing and trade-finance solutions

Expected return: A qualified pipeline and transactions followed up at 30, 60 and 90 days.

04

GUARANTEES & SME PREPARATION PARTNER

Risk Reduction and Bankability

Partner profiles: Guarantee funds, development institutions, advisory firms, accelerators and legal or financial experts

Strategic rationale: Business preparation and risk-sharing improve the quality of opportunities and accelerate decisions.

Proposed positioning: Support for the SME cohort, preparation clinics, practical tools and referral to appropriate mechanisms.

Key benefits: Deploy guarantees and technical assistance • Identify mature opportunities • Strengthen banking partnerships

Expected return: More finance-ready opportunities and faster due diligence.

05

CROSS-BORDER TRADE & LOGISTICS PARTNER

Corridors, Payments and Execution

Partner profiles: Logistics providers, airlines, carriers, insurers, payment operators and customs-solution providers

Strategic rationale: Successful transactions depend on the movement of goods, payments, insurance coverage and compliance.

Proposed positioning: Corridor session, demonstrations and B2B meetings with exporters, buyers and institutions.

Key benefits: Access businesses with real trade flows • Test solutions • Generate commercial contracts

Expected return: Qualified commercial leads and solutions deployed across priority corridors.

06

TECHNOLOGY, DATA & NEXORAPME PARTNER

Digital Trust and Matchmaking

Partner profiles: Telecommunications operators, technology companies, cloud and cybersecurity providers, data and KYC specialists, and fintechs

Strategic rationale: NexoraPME depends on high-quality data, connectivity and digital-trust mechanisms.

Proposed positioning: Partner of the Digital Trust Lab and NexoraPME, including demonstrations, technical expertise and user activation.

Key benefits: Showcase use cases • Access qualified users • Strengthen innovation positioning

Expected return: Increased adoption of digital tools and new opportunities for technology services.

INCLUSION, WOMEN & IMPACT PARTNER

SheFlies to Trade and Inclusive Entrepreneurship

Partner profiles: Impact funds, foundations, development organisations, airlines, logistics providers and women's networks

Strategic rationale: Barriers to financing, mobility and market access require coordinated, measurable solutions.

Proposed positioning: Support for a cohort, mentoring, a mobility or market-access mechanism, and participation in the SheFlies to Trade session.

Key benefits: Deliver measurable impact • Meet high-potential women entrepreneurs • Showcase ESG and CSR commitments

Expected return: Supported beneficiaries, concrete commitments and partnerships followed up after the Forum.

CONTACT AND NEXT STEPS

LET US BUILD A HIGH-IMPACT PARTNERSHIP

The CBFF-SME team is available to tailor the partnership structure, benefits, content and business objectives to your organisation.

KIGALI

+250 788 991 551

BRUXELLES

+32 491 23 54 47

The detailed programme for CBFF-SME Kigali 2026
will be released shortly.



Continental Business & Finance Forum for SMEs

CONTACT US

Secrétariat CBFF-SME

Email : info@netkigali.com

Site web : <https://cbffsme.com/>

Coordination Kigali : **+250 788 991 551**

Coordination Bruxelles : **+32 487 568 199**

Coordination Afrique de l'Ouest :

partenariat@salonpmeuemoa.org

Une plateforme d'action.

Une plateforme de transactions.

Une plateforme pour la prochaine
génération de croissance africaine.